

30-Day AI Governance Setup Plan

Company: [COMPANY NAME]

Plan owner: [AI GOVERNANCE LEAD]

Start date:

Target completion date:

How to use. This plan turns the starter kit into four weeks of practical work. It is built for small teams that need a credible first pass, not a mature enterprise program.

Before you start

Choose one person to own the first pass. That person does not need to be a lawyer or compliance officer. They need enough authority to collect tool information, ask teams for input, and schedule follow-up decisions.

Suggested owner: operations lead, founder, chief of staff, IT lead, privacy/security lead, or department head.

Week 1 - Make AI use visible

Primary document: AI Use Inventory

Goals

- Find the AI tools already in use
- Identify owners and teams
- Mark obvious sensitive-data issues
- Separate approved, under-review, and unknown tools

Tasks

- ☐ Ask each team to list AI tools they use for work
- ☐ Include personal AI accounts used for work tasks
- ☐ Add every known tool to the AI Use Inventory
- ☐ Record vendor, owner, use case, data inputs, and approval status
- ☐ Flag tools that process customer, employee, student, health, financial, legal, confidential, or regulated data
- ☐ Identify any customer-facing or decision-support use

End-of-week output

- A draft inventory with known tools and owners
- A short list of unknowns to resolve
- A list of tools or workflows that need deeper review

Week 1 meeting prompt

Which AI tools surprised us, and which ones need immediate restrictions or review?

Week 2 - Set the basic rules

Primary document: AI Acceptable Use Policy

Goals

- Define approved tools
- Write simple data rules
- Define prohibited uses
- Decide when human review is required
- Identify who approves exceptions

Tasks

- ☐ Fill in company name, owner, effective date, and policy owner
- ☐ List approved AI tools and permitted uses
- ☐ Adapt the Green / Yellow / Red AI Use Rules
- ☐ Decide what staff may never put into AI tools without approval
- ☐ Define when AI output must be reviewed before use
- ☐ Define escalation contacts for uncertain or higher-risk use
- ☐ Decide whether staff acknowledgment is required

End-of-week output

- A draft AI acceptable use policy
- A short staff-facing rules summary
- A list of policy questions that need leadership or counsel review

Week 2 meeting prompt

What rule would prevent the most likely bad AI use in our team this month?

Week 3 - Add review for new or risky use

Primary documents: AI Risk Tiering Decision Tree, AI Risk Intake and Impact Assessment, and AI Tool Approval Mini-Checklist

Goals

- Create a review path for new AI tools and workflows
- Decide which requests can use the mini-checklist
- Decide which requests need deeper review
- Record approval conditions

Tasks

- ☐ Choose who reviews new AI tool requests
- ☐ Use the risk tiering decision tree for one proposed tool or workflow
- ☐ Use the mini-checklist for one low-risk tool request as a test
- ☐ Use the risk intake and impact assessment for one higher-risk workflow or obvious gap
- ☐ Define stop-and-escalate triggers
- ☐ Add approved conditions back to the inventory
- ☐ Add material risks to the risk register
- ☐ Set next review dates for approved tools

End-of-week output

- A working request path for new AI use
- One completed sample mini-checklist, tiering record, or intake/impact assessment

- Clear escalation triggers for sensitive or higher-risk use
- A starter risk register for the risks that need follow-up

Week 3 meeting prompt

What kinds of AI use should we allow quickly, and what kinds should require review first?

Week 4 - Roll out and start the update rhythm

Primary documents: Team Rollout Message, First Governance Meeting Agenda, AI Update Tracker, What Good Looks Like

Goals

- Tell staff what changed
- Start the update log
- Assign recurring owners
- Decide what to improve next

Tasks

- ☐ Send the Team Rollout Message
- ☐ Publish the approved tools list and rules where staff can find them
- ☐ Hold the first governance meeting
- ☐ Start the AI Update Tracker
- ☐ Record open questions and next actions
- ☐ Schedule the first 30-day follow-up
- ☐ Use What Good Looks Like to check whether the first pass is complete

End-of-week output

- Staff communication sent
- Update tracker started
- Open actions assigned
- Next review meeting scheduled

Week 4 meeting prompt

What is the smallest next improvement that would reduce the most AI risk or confusion?

30-day completion summary

Area	Done enough?	Owner	Evidence / link	Follow-up
AI Use Inventory				
Acceptable Use Policy				
Green / Yellow / Red rules				
New tool review path				
Update Tracker				

Staff rollout				
Follow-up meeting scheduled				

If you get stuck

- If you cannot identify all AI tools, start with the obvious ones and keep a running open item.
- If legal questions come up, mark them for qualified review instead of guessing.
- If staff are using tools that are not approved, document the use first, then decide whether to approve, restrict, or replace it.
- If the policy feels too long, publish the one-page rules first and improve the longer policy later.

Disclaimer

This document is a template for educational and informational purposes only. It is not legal advice and does not create an attorney-client relationship. Consult qualified counsel before relying on this plan for compliance decisions.